

MB 514: Communication Skills for Managers

Course Code	MB 514
Course Name	Communication Skills for Managers
L-T-P-C	2-0-0-2 (L-T-P-C)
Prerequisites	None
Intended for	MBA
Distribution	Compulsory
Approval	50th BoA (Jul 2023)

Course Contents

- **Best Practices for Effective Communication:** This Module introduces the basic concepts of effective communication. These will include foundations of organizational communication; communication barriers and ways to overcome them; speaking and listening skills; audience centric communication framework. The objective of this module is to introduce the concepts of effective communication to the students and equipping them with strategies to craft clear and concise messages. (6 hours)
- **Persuasion and Influence:** This Module introduces persuasive communication strategies to students. This will be an inter-disciplinary module, with theories from rhetoric, strategy and negotiation informing the content. Frameworks include the Aristotelean persuasive framework, Toulmin's Method of argumentation and storytelling strategies. The application of these theories will be illustrated through appropriate case studies. (6 hours)
- **Public Speaking and Presentation Skills:** The third Module will focus on effective presentation preparation and delivery. For preparing presentations, students will learn how to craft a perfect blend of data and narrative through design, structuring of content, using multimedia, and storytelling techniques. This module will also include aspects of effective non-verbal communication, managing questions, framing presentations, using gestures and postures, and public speaking skills. Students will be required to prepare and deliver group presentations as a part of this module. (8+4 hours)
- **Workshop on Interview Skills:** The final module of this course will equip students with communication skills and strategies for cracking interviews. This module will be delivered in workshop mode, with role-plays and feedback sessions with the students. Topics covered in this module include cross-cultural communication, understanding industry narratives, techniques of articulation and frameworks for handling questions (4 hours)

Text Books

1. Bovee, Courtland L., John V. Thill and Roshan Lal Raina, **Business Communication Today**, 10th Edition, Pearson, India, 2018.

References

1. Morgan, N., Cialdini, R. B., Review, H. B., Tannen, D., **HBR's 10 Must Reads on Communication** (with Featured Article The Necessary Art of Persuasion, by Jay A. Conger), Harvard Business Review Press, 2013.

Case Studies:

1. Super Bowl Storytelling (Shelle Santana, Jill Avery) Link: <https://hbsp.harvard.edu/product/519041-PDF-ENG?Ntt=super%20bowl>
2. A Persuasion Strategy for Universita' Bocconi: An Exercise (Giovanni Gavetti) Link: <https://hbsp.harvard.edu/product/711517-PDF-ENG?activeTab=include-materials&itemFindingMethod=#educator-copy>
3. Managing Up (A): Grace (Karen MacMillan) Link: <https://hbsp.harvard.edu/product/W15269-PDF-ENG?Ntt=managing%20up%20grace>